Indians migrated to Mauritius, South Africa, Reunion Island, Seychelles, and East African region during the colonial period. Currently, Durban in South Africa is home to 1.3 million Indians. It is the largest Indian city outside India, followed by Mauritius and the Reunion Islands.

Asia-Africa Growth Corridor: The Asia-Africa Growth Corridor (AAGC) is an India-Japan economic cooperation agreement aimed at the socio-economic development of Asia and Africa. The vision document for AAGC was released by India in the 2017 African Development Bank meeting. The aim of the AAGC is to develop infrastructure and digital connectivity in Africa through India-Japan collaboration. It is viewed as an India-Japanese response to China's Belt and Road Initiative (BRI).

9.7 India-Latin America and Caribbean Relations



Background

The relationship between India and Latin America and Caribbean (LAC) has long been "Out of sight; Out of Mind". The geographical distance between them meant that there wasn't a strategic compulsion nor economic rationale to proactively build ties. Yet, the Latin America and Carribean nations and India maintained a history of warm friendship.

Latin America and Carribean nations share the spirit of anti-colonialism with India though many of them had gained independence almost a century before (19th century) India became free. Societies in Latin America and Carribean also have an ancient and rich civilizational value like India and other parts of Asia and Africa. One could hence draw similarities in some cultural practices between India and the Latin America and Carribean region. Latin America and Carribean countries such as Suriname and Guyana have a sizeable population of Indian origin who were shipped by the colonial powers as slaves centuries ago. This forms the basis of India's ties with Latin America and Carribean.

List of Countries in Latin America and Caribbean - 40

- Latin America is generally understood to consist of the entire continent of South America in addition to Mexico, Central America, and the islands of the Caribbean.
- Argentina, Bolivia, Brazil, Chile, Colombia, Costa Rica, Cuba, Dominican Republic, Ecuador, El Salvador, French Guiana, Guadeloupe, Guatemala, Haiti, Honduras, Martinique, Mexico, Nicaragua, Panama, Paraguay, Peru, Puerto Rico, Saint Barthélemy, Saint Martin, Saint Pierre and Miquelon, Uruguay, Venezuela.
- **Caribbean countries**
  Antigua and Barbuda, Bahamas, Barbados, Cuba, Dominica, Dominican Republic, Grenada, Haiti, Jamica, St. Kitts and Nevis, St. Lucia, St. Vincent and Grenadines, Trinidad and Tobago.

Post-Independence

1947-1991: After India's independence, its engagement with Latin America and Carribean was limited. State visits from India have also been negligible in this period with

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